Sidestepping Parliament

送信者: POLITICO Brussels Playbook 受信日時: 2026-11-11 14:42

【メール原文】

Presented by TikTok By GERARDO FORTUNA with MAX GRIERA CIAO THERE. Gerardo Fortuna back with you, wishing you a restful Armistice Day. Spare a thought

Presented by TikTok

By GERARDO FORTUNA

with MAX GRIERA

PRESENTED BY

Send tips here | Follow us @gerardofortuna @NicholasVinocur @GabrielGavin | Listen to Playbook and view in your browser

CIAO THERE. Gerardo Fortuna back with you, wishing you a restful Armistice Day. Spare a thought for the tech crowd busy with today's unveiling of the Digital Fairness Act.

In today's Playbook:

— Why the DFA won't stop finfluencers peddling risky investments on social media.

— The latest from the Abu Dhabi peace talks, as the clock ticks on choosing Europe's representative.

— Faces in the crowd: Marta Kos, Sergey Lavrov, Claudia Bauer, Raphaël De Wael, King Philippe of Belgium, Siegfried Mure□an, Fernando Clavijo, Fabrice Jacobsen, Jean-Marc Germain, Magnus Brunner and more …

On today's Brussels Playbook Podcast: Zoya and Ian discuss what NATO's plan to put Russia first means for the alliance's activities beyond Europe.

A message from TikTok: Did you know TikTok advertising generated €31 billion in economic output across the EU in 2025? New research shows the platform helped businesses grow, supporting €13 billion in additional economic output for small and medium-sized businesses and helping millions of businesses reach customers across borders.

DRIVING THE DAY

HOW TO BYPASS UNRULY MEPS: The decline of the once-dominant centrist forces in the European Parliament is leading to a new phenomenon: Getting positions agreed without risking all 720 MEPs voting on them, Max Griera reports.

What's happening: Normally, all MEPs get the chance to amend laws before the Parliament brings its position into negotiations with governments. But the center parties are increasingly sidestepping votes

in the plenary over fears that the chamber's shifting alliances — particularly with the far right on the rise — could blow up legislation that lawmakers who are experts on the issues have negotiated at the committee stage.

Why this matters: It's a less cozy Parliament these days, with many MEPs unwilling to toe the line. This practice is another symbol of the fragmentation of EU politics. But while the mainstream parties think it's a handy way of avoiding their compromises being unpicked, some MEPs told Playbook it raises questions about democracy.

It's "not democratic not to have it in plenary," said a senior MEP, granted anonymity to criticize the widely accepted procedure. "That's the trade-off."

But it suits the center for different reasons. The center-left S&D, for example, thinks that the shortcut shields laws from being unpicked in the plenary by the far right with center-right EPP support. The EPP, meanwhile, worries that the S&D can't control its own MEPs in the plenary — and that's why the compromises could unravel.

The simple solution for both of them? Don't risk it.

Nothing to worry about! In the full Parliament, "all the people that didn't work on the text … come with their ideas and can disturb an equilibrium that is found in the committee," Jean-Marc Germain, an S&D MEP, told our Agnes Rønberg. "The best way to proceed in this complex majority of the plenary is to go for committee mandate."

How is this allowed? The groups are using a parliamentary rule that's supposed to enable laws to be fast-tracked if there's broad consensus. As our chart below shows, the share of files handled through this procedure in the first half of 2026 was already higher than in any full year since 2019.

Where it's being used: Still reeling from plenary rebellions that derailed key laws, group leaders are allowing MEPs to bypass the chamber on long-term budget files. That's a reversal from the last budget negotiations in 2021, when they pushed for plenary votes on all files — and despite a broad majority of committee chairs urging the same approach in September.

That means hundreds of billions of euros in EU funding could head into negotiations with the Council with the backing of just 20-30 MEPs instead of a plenary majority. Of 20 budget files, 11 are expected to take that route, according to an official.

"Using this mechanism in this case is undemocratic," Raphaël De Wael, EU policy adviser at ocean protection NGO Bloom, told our Sebastian Starcevic.

There are protections, though. Lawmakers insist the process is democratic because 72 MEPs can force a plenary vote even if the committee wants to go straight to negotiations.

"The question is not whether Parliament has a mandate. We do," the EPP's lead budget negotiator Siegfried Mure□an told Playbook, arguing that committee positions were already backed by a plenary resolution adopted in April before the Commission unveiled its proposal. The committee-approved files "reflect that position, including on the figures."

As the EU's politics fractures, this is one of the ways the center is trying to retain its grip.

BIG AND BREAKING

DIGGING FOR TROUBLE: A mining giant wants to dig beneath Finland's pristine wetlands in search of critical minerals, pitting environmentalists against EU China hawks.

VIENNA'S MFF TIFF: Austrian Europe Minister Claudia Bauer rejected any compromises on the EU's next seven-year budget after her colleague Markus Marterbauer defied the government's line to show openness towards new bloc-wide taxes in an interview with Playbook . Bauer said Marterbauer expressed "his own personal view" and that "Austria's official negotiating objectives remain unchanged."

MIGRATION DEAL: The EU signed a readmission agreement with Nigeria yesterday evening that would establish a framework for returns within 30 days — part of Brussels' push to speed up deportations of unauthorized migrants through partnerships with third countries. "We are now stepping up our migration diplomacy to return those who have no right to stay," Migration Commissioner Magnus Brunner told Playbook.

Next up: Brunner will have a call today with Canary Islands President Fernando Clavijo about the recent surge in arrivals there, and he's staying in touch with Spanish Interior Minister Fernando Grande-Marlaska.

SPAIN'S HOUSING NIGHTMARE: Could Spain's housing crisis bring down the government ? Five charts tell the story.

HEGSETH OFF THE HOOK: House Republicans last night defeated an attempt to impeach Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth, sparing the Pentagon chief a trial and handing the White House a major win, my stateside colleagues report .

EUROPE'S SEAT STILL EMPTY (FOR NOW)

DEALMAKING IN THE DESERT: Ukrainian and Russian negotiators return to the table in Abu Dhabi today for the second and final day of this round of talks. Day 1 focused on security guarantees and a possible prisoner swap, my colleague Tim Ross reports from Abu Dhabi.

Next up, territory: Negotiators are expected to tackle the thorny question of territory today, according to officials briefed on the plans. Meanwhile, after months of European anxiety about being sidelined, U.S. envoys Jared Kushner and Steve Witkoff are now fully convinced Europe needs a seat at the table alongside Russia and Ukraine.

Hurry up and pick a rep: Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy wants Europe to pick its representative — and fast. Speaking to reporters in Denmark on Tuesday, he called for a "dialogue" with Kyiv over who gets the job, rather than European leaders simply presenting Ukraine with a name. "I think that in November, not late, we need to accept who will represent Europe in negotiations," Zelenskyy said.

Europe's less good news: Washington is pressing European capitals to engage with one of Moscow's long-standing demands: linking a Ukraine peace deal to a broader review of Europe's security architecture , including NATO's role.

Europe’s cunning plan: Ukraine’s allies hope that showing openness to discussing Europe’s wider security arrangements will coax Russia into making concessions in the Ukraine talks, according to officials. The trick is sequencing: Keep the two tracks moving, but hold the line against any deal on Europe’s defenses until after a peace agreement for Ukraine.

Moscow has other ideas: Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov says the reverse order — sorting out NATO-Russia relations first, Ukraine second — is “absolutely reasonable.”

Whoever gets the job of speaking for Europe in the next round of talks had better buckle up.

**Read the newsletter. Then read the room. This newsletter, and every other one we write, now has a second home in the new POLITICO app. Every name and story we mention links straight to the reporting behind it, so the story in paragraph three is one tap from everything behind it, and Pro subscribers can open the official it mentions, their record and their team. Every Playbook, from Washington to Brussels, London to Sacramento and Berlin to Canberra, sits side by side, alongside our podcasts and breaking alerts. Read it on the metro/tube, pick it up again at your desk, and keep the thread between what you read this morning and what happens next. Get the new app. **

20-SECOND PLAYBOOK PRIMER

Talks have stalled on the EU’s Automotive Package … but what’s that? Presented by the European Commission last December, the package is meant to support the auto sector as it gets cleaner. Among its aims are reforming the long-contested 2035 de facto combustion engine ban, making more batteries in Europe and slashing red tape. But member countries can’t agree on emissions targets and whether to create a new category for cars that run on alternative fuels.

TALK TO PLAYBOOK: On the Brussels Playbook Podcast, Zoya asked whether you’ve ever come across a dodgy finfluencer. WhatsApp us on +32 491 050629 and listen from 7 a.m. to hear if we give you a shout-out.

7 MORE THINGS GETTING US TALKING

EXCLUSIVE — SERBIAN STUDENTS HEAD TO BRUSSELS: Serbia’s election-winning Student List is sending a leading figure to Marta Kos’ Enlargement Forum on Nov. 16, an EU source familiar with its preparation told Playbook. It’ll be the movement’s first public appearance in Brussels to spell out its EU vision.

A sneak peek: Playbook spoke to three student representatives last week. Their message? European values: yes. EU membership as an immediate priority: not quite. “A lot of people are not capable of having informed opinions about many subjects, not just [the] EU,” said Student List’s Jovana Pavloviç. “These topics shouldn’t be focused [on] until we have free media.”

SCOOP — NEW CONSUMER COP: The European Commission wants direct enforcement powers in consumer protection cases where breaches by large companies affect two-thirds of member countries and two-thirds of the EU population, according to a Commission presentation obtained by Sebastian Starcevic and Eliza Gkritsi.

PHONY FINFLUENCERS: Brussels wants to crack down on manipulative online sales tricks with its Digital Fairness Act, but the NGO Finance Watch says the rules won’t go far enough to rein in social media

influencers who peddle risky investments. More in Morning Financial Services for subscribers .

COSTA WINKS AT MERZ: European Council President António Costa has replied to Friedrich Merz's letter linking the EU's next budget to unanimous backing for a multibillion-euro Ukraine loan (which didn't go down well with the V4 countries). In a letter seen by Playbook, Costa confirmed both issues will go together on the agenda at the Nov. 26-27 summit, with Ukraine also getting airtime at this week's informal Dublin gathering.

NATO GOES BACK TO BASICS: The alliance wants to put fighting Russia first and to scale back forces dedicated to missions abroad.

PORTUGAL VS. RUTTE: Lisbon has blasted NATO chief Mark Rutte for suggesting it downplays the Russian threat, calling his remarks "regrettable."

MAKING WAVES: Greek Prime Minister Kyriakos Mitsotakis intends to raise Libya and Turkey's controversial maritime border deal at Friday's informal meeting of EU leaders in Dublin, Nektaria Stamouli and Martina Sapio report.

BRUSSELS CORNER

WEATHER: Cloudy and wet. High of 7C.

FLAGS AT HALF-MAST: EU and Bulgarian flags will fly at half-mast today at Council and Parliament buildings in solidarity with Bulgaria after the tragic motorway accident yesterday that killed at least 12 and injured dozens of others . Sofia has declared today a day of national mourning.

Poland's Permanent Representation to the EU has rescheduled its Independence Day reception in Brussels for Nov. 20, officials told Playbook. The event, originally planned for Monday at Autoworld, was postponed following Saturday's deadly shooting in Kraków and the declaration of national mourning. New invitations will follow.

MARKING ARMISTICE DAY: It was 108 years ago today that allied powers and Germany signed the agreement to end World War I. Here's how Belgium is remembering the fallen …

In Brussels, there'll be a ceremony at the Congress column, where members of the government, the parliament and King Philippe will be among those paying tribute to the "unknown soldier " and the victims of both world wars.

To the trenches: In Ypres — home of the Flanders Fields battleground where, according to the famous poem , "the poppies blow" — there's a packed day planned, including a poppy parade, a concert and (as happens in Ypres every day) the sounding of the Last Post.

While you're there … pop by the nearby Sint-Sixtus Abbey, which produces the famous but hard-to-get Westvleteren trappist beer that's often been named the best in the world. You can try some at the aptly named "In de Vrede" ("In the Peace") brasserie next door.

Run for peace: The development group 11.11.11 has organized "jogging de la paix " in Berchem-Sainte-Agathe this afternoon. Not tempted? There'll also be a ping-pong tournament.

STARTING TODAY: The Fifty Lab Music Festival will showcase around 65 emerging musical acts in a range of genres over the next three days.

TOP OF THE PLAYBOOKS

Berlin: Friedrich Merz is keeping his 71st birthday low-key , though he could get a timely gift if tough budget talks deliver the electricity tax cut he championed.

Paris: Far-right Reconquest leader Eric Zemmour launched his presidential bid last night with a promise to “keep France French” ⋯ now he just needs to scrape together enough signatures from elected officials to get on the ballot.

Madrid: Spain is braced for its first general strike in 14 years as workers protest over housing and rising living costs — but this time, the prime minister isn’t on the opposing side.

London: Andy Burnham faces the Commons at prime minister’s questions before flying to COP31, the first stop in a two-day diplomatic whirlwind.

Read more from our Playbook family: Washington ⋯ Ottawa ⋯ Canberra .

AGENDA

— Ukraine, Russia and the U.S. continue trilateral peace talks in Abu Dhabi.

— Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy visits the Danish parliament in Copenhagen and addresses lawmakers, from 11 a.m.

— The U.N. Climate Change Conference (COP31) continues in Antalya, Turkey, with Commission President Ursula von der Leyen participating.

— Press conference on the European Commission’s Digital Fairness Act and a consumer enforcement initiative with Executive Vice President Henna Virkkunen and Consumer Protection Commissioner Michael McGrath. Watch live .

— Coreper I meets at 9 a.m. and Coreper II at 9:30 a.m.

— EU foreign policy chief Kaja Kallas meets Yemen’s Foreign Minister Afrah Al-Zouba. Mediterranean Commissioner Dubravka Šuica and Humanitarian Aid Commissioner Hadja Lahbib are also scheduled to meet Al-Zouba.

— NATO Secretary-General Mark Rutte visits Norway to attend the Atlantic Future Forum on board the HMS Prince of Wales aircraft carrier. He tours the ship with U.K. Defence Secretary Wes Streeting and Norwegian Foreign Minister Espen Barth Eide.

— Defense Commissioner Andrius Kubilius participates in a Munich Security Conference Technology Security Roundtable in Brussels.

— Virkkunen delivers a keynote speech at the launch of the Drone Industrial Forum (D-TECT) and takes part in a European Parliament debate on cyber resilience and the protection of critical infrastructure and supply chains.

— Lahbib takes part in a European Parliament debate on the proposed EU civil protection mechanism and support for health emergency preparedness and response.

— Mediterranean Commissioner Dubravka Šuica meets Spanish Foreign Minister José Manuel Albares.

— Fisheries Commissioner Costas Kadis speaks at the OACPS-EU Joint Parliamentary Assembly and meets Belgian Justice and North Sea Minister Annelies Verlinden.

— Financial Services Commissioner Maria Luís Albuquerque delivers a keynote speech and takes part in Latvijas Banka's conference "From Policy to Impact" in Riga.

BIRTHDAYS

MEPs Javi López and Emma Ytterell; former MEP Filip De Man; POLITICO alums Matthew Kaminski and Elisabeth Binard; POLITICO's Cristina Gonzalez; Denmark's permanent representation to the EU spokesperson Fabrice Jacobsen; European Commission's Nadège Defrère; Permanent Representative of the Slovak Republic to the EU Juraj Nociar; German Chancellor Friedrich Merz; Daniel Ortega, co-president of Nicaragua. Poland's Independence Day. Armistice Day.

Playbook is brought to you by POLITICO's EU Politics team: Gerardo Fortuna, Nicholas Vinocur, Gabriel Gavin, Zoya Sheftalovich, Max Griera, Mari Eccles, Hanne Cokelaere, Lucia Mackenzie, Gregorio Sorgi and Sebastian Starcevic. And: reporters Milena Wälde and Daria Zakharova, editors Alex Spence and James Panichi, and producers Dean Southwell and Hugh Kapernaros.

A message from TikTok: Did you know TikTok advertising generated €31 billion in economic output across the EU in 2025? The platform helped businesses grow, acting as a discovery engine for opportunity across the European economy new independent research shows. The impact goes well beyond the app. Advertising on TikTok helped generate €13 billion in additional economic output for small and medium-sized businesses, while more than 6.5 million EU businesses used TikTok to reach customers across borders. Discovery on TikTok helps small businesses connect with new customers, creators reach new audiences, and useful ideas and skills travel between countries. These connections can translate into real-world growth, from increased sales for local businesses to new opportunities for entrepreneurs and creators. Across the EU, TikTok is turning online discovery into economic activity , helping businesses grow and connecting people and products across borders.

SUBSCRIBE to the POLITICO newsletter family: Brussels Playbook | Brussels Playbook Capitals | London Playbook | London Playbook PM | Playbook Paris | Berlin Playbook | Madrid Playbook | Sunday Crunch | EU Influence | London Influence | D.C. Playbook | D.C. Influence | Decoded | Canada Playbook | POLITICO Forecast | Canberra Playbook | All our POLITICO Pro policy morning newsletters

---

This email was sent to shondo@iies.co.jp
Update your preferences | Unsubscribe from this email | Unsubscribe from all emails
POLITICO SRL · Rue de la Loi 62 · Brussels 1040 · Belgium